

**KICKING AROUND**  
Chris Dore of Lorain Catholic earns spot on national soccer team **B7**



**DOUG CLARKE**

Colerain commits sin of (forced) admission **B2**

**BASEBALL**

Tribe regular season is all sold out **B5**

**NFL**

Browns and Chargers fall on hard times **B8**

# Sports

The Chronicle / SUNDAY, DECEMBER 3, 1995 **B1**



**DAN COUGHLIN**

## You say you want a revolution?

A guy in the Baltimore Sun ridiculed the Ohio politicians who trotted down to Washington to protest the Browns' move and he scoffed at the Browns Backers demonstrating on the steps of the Capitol Building.

Better wake up, man, or you'll miss the revolution. What happened in Washington this past week was a modern Boston Tea Party.

Under the old thinking, his disdain might have been justified. But that was before the moguls who own the teams began demanding public subsidies.

Congress has every reason to become interested in the National Football League and other pro sports because they are a public subsidy industry and should be scrutinized from that perspective.

They can no longer hide behind the mantra of "free enterprise."

The only thing free about the NFL is the free ride it is getting on the public dole as taxpayers give away \$200 million stadiums.

The lofty thinkers in Congress have always pretended that football and baseball are beneath them, that it demeans their high office to expend official energy on children's games.

Typical was the reaction of Browns linebacker Carl Banks when I asked him what he thought about the Congressional hearings.

"Talk to me about something important," said Banks, who carries himself like an intellectual.

"Talk to me about government cutbacks. Talk to me about welfare. Talk to me about the elderly," Banks said arrogantly.

Talk to me about the conspiracy among millionaire players and millionaire owners who are sucking public money out of other programs. That's what these Congressional hearings are about. They transcend Art Modell and the Cleveland Browns. They are about an industry that pleads for government surveillance.

Those are terrible words — "government surveillance" — in a country that already has too much government.

But to put it in simplistic terms, the National Football League has applied for welfare and that is everybody's business.

Heretofore, nobody paid much attention to the NFL's welfare status. When the Rams moved from Anaheim to St. Louis and when the Raiders moved from Los Angeles back to Oakland, nobody blinked outside of those communities.

But the Browns' move has caused a national tidal wave of awareness. The entire league is shellshocked by the reaction from 210 Browns Backers clubs with 85,000 members who are inundating other franchise owners and the league office with phone calls and faxes.

I am told that confusion is rampant in the league offices in New York, where they're up to their hip pockets in alligators.

Art Modell claims that he would have gone out of business without a \$200 million bailout for a new stadium. It did not matter where the bailout came from — Cleveland, Baltimore, wherever. He needed the public money. He got it.

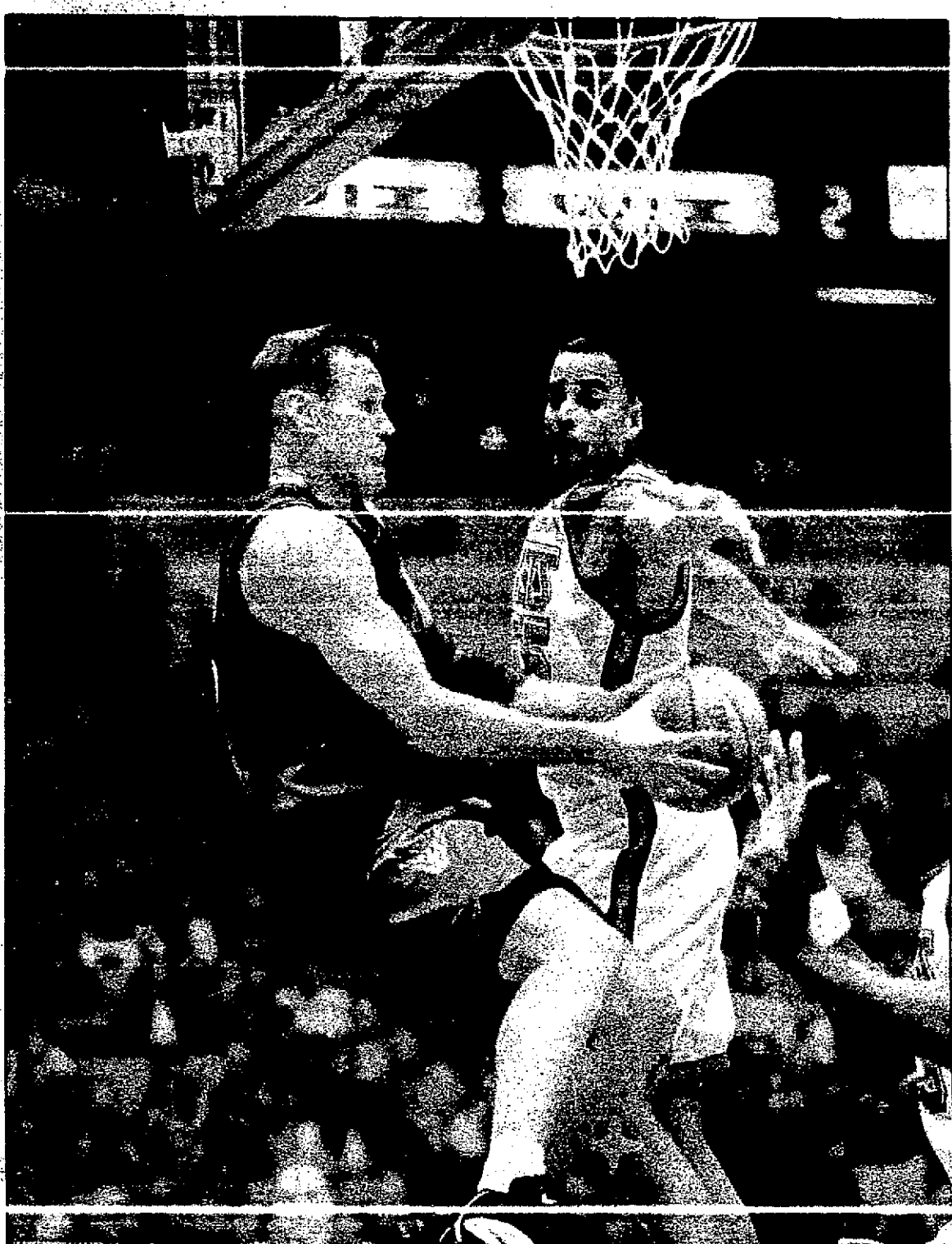
Owners of teams in Philadelphia, Tampa, Phoenix, Seattle, Houston and Cincinnati are also applying for welfare.

Explicitly, a monopoly doing gangbuster business is failing.

It seems that the business needs a new plan or it should be allowed to go out of business.

The idea of building \$200 million stadiums to be used 10 or 11 times a year is so absurd that the

See COUGHLIN, B5



**IN-AIR DECISION:** The Cavs Dan Majerle looks for someone to pass to as Jayson Williams closes in.

## Youth, defense carry Buckeyes past CSU

**Jim Jablonski**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

**COLUMBUS** — Oh, to be young, talented and a Buckeye.

A basketball playing Buckeye that is.

It remains to be seen just how talented the freshman-laden Ohio State team is, but the Buckeyes did run their record to 3-0 Saturday night with a 75-52 victory over visiting Cleveland State, which fell to 1-2. OSU lost to the Vikings, 75-73, at Gund Arena

last year but now holds a 4-1 advantage in the series.

A perfect record against teams like Central Connecticut and West Virginia might not sound like much, but coming off a 6-22 season, and starting four freshmen, coach Randy Ayers has to be happy with his team's start.

"I thought we gutted it out today," Ayers said. "We struggled from an offensive standpoint in the first half but we stayed with what we had to do over a 40-minute game."

What the Buckeyes had to do

was make use of their versatility. They did that as nine players scored while only senior Ricky Yudt and freshman Neshawn Coleman scored as many as 12.

"We're trying to establish our rotation right now," Ayers continued. "I'm comfortable with an eight-man rotation and then substituting based on the situation."

Ohio State trailed 6-2 in the early going but a 12-0 run started and ended by jumpers from freshman Jermaine Tate put the Bucks up 14-6.

But Cleveland State, making

use of the six-point halves of center Eric Nicholson and guard Joe Rey fought back to a 23-22 deficit with 2:52 remaining.

At that point Yudt, the Buckeye lone senior starter, took over. Scoring on a quick pair of jumpers, Yudt began a 10-2 OSU run that put the Bucks up 33-24 at the half.

"That (the 10-2) was very encouraging," Ayers said. "We had struggled up to that point. Yet we had enough to go into the locker room with a nine-point lead. Then we came out and

played solidly in the second half."

Yudt and his senior teammate Steve Belter, a CSU transfer to Ohio State, exchanged baskets for the first 11 points that increased the lead to 44-32 and the Vikings never threatened again.

Coach Mike Boyd of CSU saw the difference coming on the boards.

"I thought we did a good job defensively in the first half but they scored 12 points in the first half on second shots.

See BUCKEYES, B5

## Finally, EC gets big win

**Paul Heyse**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

**ELYRIA** — When Ed Zaborniak rebounds, the Elyria Catholic junior snatches the basketball with authority — and for good reason.

A year ago, the Panthers' inside game simply did not exist with the lack of any true big men. Re-establishing the lost facet of EC's game, the 6-foot-4 Zaborniak hauled in 11 rebounds and scored 11 points off the bench in leading the Panthers to a 48-34 victory over Midview at the Coliseum Friday night.

While his scoring was obviously pivotal, Zaborniak's rebounding was even more so as it gave EC a 25-17 edge on the boards.

"I think rebounding is a bigger part of my game," said Zaborniak. "At the high school level, I've never been much of a scorer, I'm more of a rebounder. If that's some way I can help the team, I'll try my hardest at it and whatever happens happens."

Both Elyria Catholic (1-1 overall) and Midview (0-2) struggled for accuracy the first half. Grab-



**SWAT'S UP?** Elyria West's Brad Schnell knocks the ball away from Olmsted Falls' Jerome Moore while West's Daimion Mahone looks on.

## Falls stands tall in drilling West

**Tim Gebhardt**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

**OLMSTED FALLS** — No doubt about it, Olmsted Falls has the complete package this year on the basketball floor.

They can shoot. They can rebound. They can play defense.

Saturday, the Bulldogs took apart Elyria West, 62-33, beating the Wolverines in every phase of the game.

The Bulldogs shot nearly 50 percent from the field (20 of 43), missed only two of 17 free throws, grabbed 29 rebounds to West's 18, and held high-scoring Nate Crutcher to just a handful of points in an impressive early season display.

"They have a nice ballclub," said West coach Mitch Gillam. "They shoot the ball well and they give you some defensive trouble simply because they have a much stronger inside game than we have with their big people."

"It's like I told the kids, we had some things exposed tonight. We just got to get back and get to work on it. I didn't see anything out there tonight that couldn't be corrected. It's early."

Perhaps Falls felt it had some-

thing to prove after its lackluster opening performance against Brookside on Friday. Whatever, the Bulldogs scored the game's first seven points and never relinquished the lead.

"We played much better tonight," said Falls coach Pat Donahue. "I think the kids were a little more focused."

"One of the things we've been talking about is we need to step up and play better defense and we have. I know we can score points but the problem is we can stop people from scoring."

Saturday night, Falls did just that. The Bulldogs denied West good looks at the basket by pushing them to the perimeter with a sticky man defense. When the Wolverines did get a shot off, it missed most of the time and Falls' taller inside players were there to grab the rebound.

West, after hitting 23 of 42 shots from the field against Midview on Friday, managed only 14 of 41 Saturday and missed all 11 of its attempts in the second period when Falls put the game away.

Tim Schaefer, Falls' 6-foot-8

See WEST, B5

## Cavs blow big lead

Second-half troubles end win streak at four

**Tom Canavan**  
Associated Press

**EAST RUTHERFORD, N.J.** — Not only are the New Jersey Nets winning at home, they're doing it in the face of adversity.

With only eight players available, leading scorer Armon Gilliam sidelined with an ankle injury and Kenny Anderson having a horrible game, the Nets overcame a 17-point second-half deficit to beat the Cleveland Cavaliers 79-78 Saturday night.

"I'll tell you how we won," Nets coach Butch Beard said. "We had eight guys giving everything they possibly could, physically and emotionally. We won on pure grit."

The Nets, who are now unbeaten in six home games, had a lot of heroes in winning their season-high third straight game.

Kevin Edwards hit a go-ahead jumper from just inside the 3-point line with 35 seconds left. As important as Edwards' shot was the Nets' defense. It held Cleveland to 28 second-half points and just five in the final five minutes.

"Everybody's pulling for each other, everybody's working hard," said Jayson Williams, who led the Nets with 17 points and a career-high 17 rebounds. "Most of all, everybody is having fun. The

### TONIGHT

**WHO:** Cavs vs. Mavericks

**TIME:** 7:30

**WHERE:** Gund Arena

**TV/RADIO:** SportsChannel  
WWW: AM-1100 WEOL AM-930

little stuff that distracted us last year is not distracting us this year."

The loss snapped a four-game winning streak for the Cavaliers and it was only their second setback in eight games.

The win was the second in as many nights for the Nets since the deal that sent Derrick Coleman to Philadelphia for Shawn Bradley in a six-player swap.

None of the new players were in the lineup Saturday and Gilliam's injury reduced the work force to eight players. Anderson, who scored 39 points on Friday against Boston, had just two on 1-of-7 shooting in 30 minutes.

"That's what good teams are made of," said backup point guard Chris Childs, who scored seven of his nine points in the Nets' final 12.5 min. "You win when things happen like that, where you lose guys and you're not at full strength. Maybe this is

See CAVS, B5